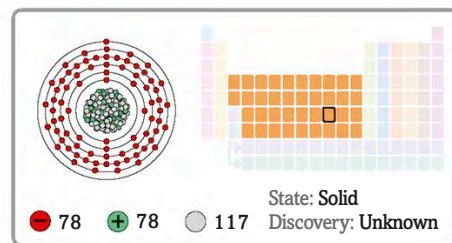


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Pt

Platinum



Forms

This dense, shiny mineral consisting of platinum and arsenic is the most common ore of platinum.

Platinum melts at the high temperature of **1,768°C** (3,214°F).

Nugget of pure platinum refined in a laboratory

Sperrylite

Large nuggets of pure platinum are rare.



Spanish explorers first found platinum in the mines of South America in the 1700s.

They obtained a whitish substance that the locals living near there called *platina*, meaning “little silver”. This precious metal has a silvery white shine. Platinum rarely reacts with other elements,

even at high temperatures. This makes it difficult to extract from its ores, such as **sperrylite**. **Pure platinum** does not corrode or tarnish. It is, however, not easy to shape or mould, so use of platinum was limited to the making of simple jewellery and **watches**. By the 20th century,